

Multiplication

It's easy to count small numbers of things.
But what if you have lots of things to count?

If we have lots of things to count,
it can be easier to count in groups.

We can count the socks in pairs.
There are 2 socks in every pair.



A jumble of socks.



$$2 + 2 + 2 + 2 + 2 = 10 \text{ socks}$$

This sum uses ADDITION.

How many pairs do we have? We have 5 pairs of socks.
This sum can also be written as

$$5 \times 2 = 10 \text{ socks}$$

This time we're using
MULTIPLICATION.

5×2 is the same as 2×5 .
The sums are written in different
ways but their answers are the same.

Another way of saying "multiplied by" is to say "TIMES".
The multiplication, or times, sign is $\times$.